



NVIDIA develops AI image creator

NVIDIA AI based image creator "GauGAN" turns sketches into photorealistic landscapes in seconds. <https://digit.in/apr19-41>



HP's new Reverb VR headset

HP's newest VR headset called Reverb sports hi-res optics, inside-out tracking, and lightweight design. <https://digit.in/apr19-42>



A BOUNTY OF BUGS

Finding bugs for a living could be a legitimate career choice

Arnab Mukherjee | arnab@digit.in

"B

ecome a hacker", said no Indian parent ever to their kids. If your's did, congratulations on having an

awesome set of parents. The perception of hacking in the country was pretty much non-existent up until the availability of affordable internet connectivity, and even then the perception remains pretty misguided. Except for the tech savvy, most

individuals, parents or otherwise view the role of hacker as something purely malicious, going as far as labelling hacking skills as criminal tendencies.

However, the job market tends to think ahead and think differently, especially when it comes technology roles. The National Association of Software and Services Companies (NASSCOM) recently estimated that India will need 1 million cybersecurity professionals by 2020 to meet the demands of its rapidly growing economy.. Even without the accompanying statistics, the need for cybersecurity personnel is evident in the number of leaks happening every single day. While there are a myriad roles within the cybersecurity domain that are required to fill this gap, we're going to focus on one particular role - a bug bounty hunter.

WHAT DOES A BUG BOUNTY HUNTER DO?

To get a basic understanding of the role, the name itself is quite self explanatory. A bug bounty hunter looks for bugs in applications and platforms, which they later reveal to the company responsible and are compensated for the same. Numerous companies run established bug bounty programs with predefined rewards. For instance, in India, Ola runs the Security Bug Bounty Program under which it has defined rewards upto ₹3 lakh for Injections, Server Side or client side issues, Bypassing significant security controls and more. Other companies like Pay-TM, Mobikwik, Yatra and McDelivery, the delivery arm of McDonalds, also have their own bug bounty programs.

WHY BE A BUG BOUNTY HUNTER?

HackerOne is a platform that connects businesses with its community of cybersecurity researchers who work on finding bugs and breaches on their platforms. The 2019 Hacker Report from HackerOne outlines a lot of interesting facts about the role of a bug bounty hunter.

The pay

According to HackerOne, India remains the top location for hackers the second year in a row, with 27% of the pool coming from the country this year, whereas on BugCrowd, India comprises nearly 24% of the members. In terms of payment, the United States paid the most with \$33,658,784 being paid out in bounties. Interestingly, India is also one of the leaders on the board in terms of bounty earned. Indian hackers earned a total of \$4,982,260 in the HackerOne community. Due to the global nature of this role, it isn't entirely fair to limit payout sources to only those of Indian origin. In a May 2017 Hacker Powered Security report, it was shown that that white hat hackers in India netted \$1.8M in bounties. Back in 2016, when Facebook released statistics pertaining to its own bug bounty program upon